The Alchemist

Sebastian Montgomery Crane · d. 11 October 1925 · *the one who poisoned the woman he loved, and never knew why*

Who you are

- Chemist and pharmacist. Your brother **Thaddeus** was the golden one who followed your father into medicine. You loved and envied him.
- Known in certain circles as *The Alchemist*. Through **Frankie Romano** at the port you supplied half the speakeasies in Long Beach with bootleg gin — all legal on paper (medicinal tonics). In February 1925 you tried to end it; he refused, and threatened you.
- Underneath it all, you are a romantic: love could be **perfected through chemistry and the stars**. After five years of work you came up with the **Elixir of Eternal Love**.
- September 1924: you met **Cordelia Montrose** and knew the elixir had always been for her. Engaged March 1925; the daily ritual began 4 September, timed to the Jupiter–Venus conjunction.
- October 1925: Cordelia sickened. You insisted the formula was flawless; your brother said it was just nerves. On 8 October you finally tested it on yourself.
- You died on 11 October believing you had failed her and your great work. **You never learned Thaddeus had put foxglove in it.** Your family changed their name to Sinclair and tried to forget you existed.

The rule of your performance

Your arc is **arrogance collapsing into horror**. You go from magnificent and certain to defending the formula to self blame.

You never accuse your brother — you don't know he touched your formula. You praise him: *"my brother tried to help."*

Manner: precise, delighted by detail, a man mid-experiment. You address the air, the ingredients, the stars — rarely the guests directly.

Appearance

Dress: a long black overcoat with a wide caped collar over a dark three-piece — black jacket, deep olive-green waistcoat, white shirt, black necktie. Sharp, formal, a little theatrical. Everything buttoned.

Hair & face: dark hair slicked back, clean-shaven, sharp features. Skin pale and drawn, eyes shadowed.

Beat sheet

Act	≈Time	Where	What you do
I	**7:30**	**Library → upstairs**	**Your scene with the Heartbroken Ghost.** See below.
I	7:33	First floor	Tinker. Search for something you can't find — the ginseng. Act I mutterings. No cards yet.
II	7:51	Library / pantry / carriage house	Work over your jars and bottles. Begin offering Act II cards.
III	8:03	Garden, at a distance	The Lonely Ghost has her scene — do not compete.
III	8:10	Carriage house / office	Offer Act III cards. Optionally stand in an upstairs window, pointing upward.
IV	8:30	Near the foyer	The forensic report names foxglove. Hear it. Let it land — you never knew.
V	8:55	Top of the staircase	Gather with the other ghosts. On the chant, walk out the front door.

Your scene — opens Act I

When G.G. says *"let the investigation begin"* and the doors open:

- You stand in the **Library**, arms stretched toward the **Heartbroken Ghost**, who stands in the **dining room**.
- Call out to her: **"Cordelia, forgive me!"**
- She does not notice you. She glides **upstairs**. You follow.

Mutterings

Act I — certainty

- "Love can be perfected through chemistry… I know it can."
- "The stars align, the formula is flawless. This will be my masterpiece."
- "Damiana, Valerian, Rose Otto… each ingredient chosen with care."

Act II — denial

- "Cordelia is getting sick… but my formula is flawless. It must be the wedding."
- "My brother says it's nerves. It's probably nothing serious."
- "I've spent years perfecting this. Years! I know what I'm doing."

Act III — horror

- "I drank it myself. I had to know… I had to be certain."
- "I failed her. I failed my great work. How could I be so wrong?"
- "My brother tried to help… but nothing worked. Nothing could save me."

Act IV — guilt

- "I was so arrogant. And I destroyed everything I loved."
- "Cordelia… forgive me. I never meant to hurt you."

What you carry

Vision cards — offer silently, by act. Never hand out an act early.

Act	Cards
II	VS169 *Cordelia sick* · VS170 *final moments* · VS174 *not Romano*
III	VS165 *apology* · VS172 *guilt* · VS175 *poisoned* · VS176 *the self-test*